

BARBADOS ALOE

Aloe vera

Throughout history, aloe vera has healed the sick and made the old feel youthful. Even Cleopatra is reputed to have used aloe as part of her daily skincare regime.

Today, it's still vital to the health and beauty industry and makes a fine architectural plant for any windowsill.

“I am a living pharmacy—the ‘plant of immortality.’”

Help me thrive



POSITION

Happy in direct sunlight or bright indirect light and in temperatures of 70–80°F (20–25°C), though not dropping below 50°F (10°C).



POTTING

Use a well-drained compost with plenty of grit. Repot when the plant is too crowded with suckers or remove them to repot and give away.



GROWTH RATE

This plant can reach heights of 24in (60cm). It will spread by suckering, but this can be limited by restricting the size of the container.



CARE

Water every 3 weeks in spring and summer to keep leaves plump, letting the soil dry out in between. In winter, once a month may be fine.



I'll clean your air

I can help alleviate ear, nose, and throat irritation by reducing levels of formaldehyde in the air, which is given off from everyday household detergent and soap products.



Care and share

If I am thriving, you may spot babies at my base, and you can spread the love by gifting these to friends and family. Once they reach 3in (7cm) tall, pull away each baby plant, with its roots, and pot them in free-draining compost.

